RPI Graduate Council

MOTION

Rensselaer Union Graduate Council
Date: Feb 26th, 2025

WHEREAS the Graduate Council is the representative body for the Graduate portion of the Union membership and is responsible for ensuring adequate representation of all graduate student cohorts (PhD, Masters' and Co-Term) within its membership;

WHEREAS to ensure diverse representation from the graduate community, it is deemed necessary to include explicit provisions in our Graduate Council ByLaws, for ensuring adequate representation of Masters' and Co-term students within the Graduate Council; and

WHEREAS Article IV of the prevalent Graduate Student Council ByLaws, *dt. 19 February 2025*, outlines the criteria for constituting the voting and non-voting membership of the Graduate Student Council;

The Graduate Council hereby RESOLVES to

Amend the Graduate Student Council ByLaws, *dt. 19 February 2025*, as follows:

1. Addition of **Article IV, Clause B, Sl. No. 4.3**, to be read as below:
   "The Graduate Council shall make reasonable efforts to ensure that both Masters' and Co-term students of the Union Graduate community are adequately represented in the Graduate Council. The Council will endeavor to ensure that at least one Graduate Senator position and at least one Graduate Representative position of the Council are occupied by Masters' and/or Co-term students."

2. Addition of **Article IV, Clause B, Sl. No. 4.4**, to be read as below:
   "If the at-large Graduate Council membership is full (i.e. all Graduate Senators and all at-large Graduate Representatives have been elected) without any representation from the Masters' and/or Co-term student cohort and any eligible student of the subject cohort wishes to be represented on the Council; then, each year, a single additional at-will Graduate Representative seat will be opened for any interested applicant from the subject unrepresented cohort. These at-will open seats shall not be opened by default: the requirement for the open seat shall be determined not before the completion of Grand Marshal Week elections each year and the open seat shall cease to exist at the conclusion

of each term. Once opened, the seat shall be filled according to the standard procedure for vacancies as detailed in Article V, Clause E later."

3. Amendment of **Article IV, Clause C, Sl. No. 4** *(which defines the non-voting membership of the Graduate Student Council)*, to be henceforth read as below:
"The president or their designated representative of any other departmental graduate ~~*organization*~~ representative body or independent graduate organization at Rensselaer, that advocates for graduate interests and/or ~~*holds or plans*~~ conducts social events, primarily to serve the graduate community at Rensselaer. ~~*These graduate organizations include, but are not limited to: the School of Science Council, the Center for Biotechnology and Interdisciplinary Studies Council, and the MANE Student Advisory Council.*~~

Such non-voting representation may include and shall not be limited to:

a. The different departmental graduate councils or graduate student advisory bodies operating under the Schools of Engineering (viz. ECSE GC, BME GC, MANE Student Advisory Council and others), Science (viz. Physics GC, ITWS GC and others), HASS (viz. STS GC, CogSci GSA and others) and Lally School of Management (Lally GC),
b. The different independent graduate organizations, operating in Rensselaer, from time to time (viz. Grad SWE, Students with Families and others) and
c. The different Union-recognized graduate bodies, active in the Rensselaer Union, from time to time (viz. BGSA, Bangladeshi Students Association and others).

Further, such non-voting representation, as given by the Clause IV.C.4 above, shall not be ex-officio and shall require a formal written request from the president of the respective graduate body or organization to the President of the Graduate Student Council. All such requests shall be automatically approved and the Graduate Student Council shall not have any discretionary authority to deny them under any pretext.

So Moved By	And Seconded By	Vote
Subhangshu Sen Graduate Senator	Diyanko Bhowmik Graduate Senator	10-0-1

Passes | Fails